



# Even Keel

Our December 2026 link — what changes for you, in plain English

A proposal for discussion · CEA link · 26 weeks · code EK-26-H1

# The short version

Five things to take away if you remember nothing else

**35h**

**the contracted  
week, as now**

no extra hours

**5**

**most days  
in a row**

up to 6 · today 7

**14**

**full weekends  
off a year**

today 10 · 7 in 26

**8 of 15**

**shift times you  
already work**

7 new ones

**30 min**

**off every  
closing shift**

Sundays: 45 min

**Same hours, shorter closers, weekends off never more than five weeks apart, and one shift time most weeks.**

# Why the link has to change

Nobody is changing it for the sake of it



## **A new timetable in December 2026**

More trains, at new times — the link has to follow them.



## **More of us on the link**

It grows from 20 weeks to 26, so six more colleagues join it.



## **New staffing levels**

At least 10 on a Sunday, and more at the open and the close. We also aim for 14 on a Saturday.



## **The ticket office in fixed pairs**

Two early and two late, on the same shifts, every day.

**The change is coming whatever we do — the question is which version we want.**

# Will I work more?

The first thing everyone asks

|                                | Today | Even Keel    |
|--------------------------------|-------|--------------|
| Contracted hours a week        | 35h   | <b>35h</b>   |
| Contracted days at work a week | 4.20  | <b>4.19</b>  |
| Contracted days at work a year | 219.0 | <b>218.6</b> |

**No. The same 35-hour week on average and no more days; weeks run from 24h 30m to 41h 30m (today 25h 10m to 43h 50m), and two more of the days fall on a Saturday.**

# Will my basic pay change?

Basic pay follows your contracted hours

|                                         | Today | Even Keel  |
|-----------------------------------------|-------|------------|
| Contracted hours a week                 | 35h   | <b>35h</b> |
| Saturdays a year, at time and a quarter | 26    | <b>28</b>  |
| Sunday overtime to share — each, a year | 21    | <b>20</b>  |

**No. The same 35-hour week — plus about two more Saturdays at time and a quarter.**

# Will my shifts be longer?

Every closing shift gets shorter — the average goes up about two minutes

|                                           | Today  | Even Keel |
|-------------------------------------------|--------|-----------|
| Weekday closer — starts 15:45, not 15:15  | 8h 40m | 8h 10m    |
| Saturday closer — starts 15:15, not 14:45 | 9h 10m | 8h 40m    |
| Sunday closer — starts 15:15, not 14:30   | 8h 55m | 8h 10m    |
| Longest shift anywhere                    | 9h 10m | 9h 00m    |
| Average shift                             | 8h 14m | 8h 16m    |

**Every closing shift is 30 to 45 minutes shorter; the longest early turn goes from 8h 30m to 9h 00m, and nothing runs over 9 hours.**

# Will I finish late more often?

5 more a year after 23:00 (44, today 39); 16 more at 22:00 or later (94, today 78)

|                                            | Today   | Even Keel |
|--------------------------------------------|---------|-----------|
| Finishing at 23:00 or later — each, a year | 39      | 44        |
| Finishing at 22:00 or later — each, a year | 78      | 94        |
| Starting at 06:20 — each, a year           | 62      | 60        |
| Shortest gap between two shifts            | 12h 30m | 14h 35m   |

**More people stay on after 22:00 under the December staffing; five more a year after 23:00, four to the Saturday close.**

# Will I know the times?

15 shift times in all — 8 of them you already work



## You work these today (8)

- 06:20–14:00
- 06:20–14:20
- 06:20–14:50
- 07:15–15:45
- 11:00–19:30
- 14:00–22:30
- 14:30–22:00
- 15:15–23:55



## New times (7)

### Weekdays

- 14:45–22:30 — a new late, ending with the ticket office
- 15:45–23:55 — the closer, 30 minutes later than 15:15

### Saturday

- 06:20–15:00 — a new early, 8h 40m
- 07:45–16:45 — a new early, 9 hours

### Sunday

- 15:15–23:25 — the closer, 45 minutes later than 14:30
- 09:00–18:00 — a new early, 9 hours
- 14:30–22:30 — the ticket-office late

**Fewer shift times than today (15, not 18) — and several of the new ones are shorter versions of today's lates.**

# Rest and weekends

The biggest improvement over today

|                                         | Today       | Even Keel   |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------|-------------|
| Full weekends off, about a year         | 10          | 14          |
| Most days worked in a row               | 7 (up to 9) | 5 (up to 6) |
| Rest-day breaks of two days or more     | 13 of 17    | 22 of 26    |
| Shortest gap between two shifts         | 12h 30m     | 14h 35m     |
| Weeks on one turn, no early-late switch | 7 of 16     | 18 of 21    |

**14 full weekends off a year, at most five weeks apart, and one shift time in 18 of 21 weeks.**

# Your 26 weeks at a glance

The green bars are the full weekends off; where you start is decided later



**14 full weekends off a year, at most five weeks apart; blocks of earlies or lates up to 5 weeks, 12 if the cover weeks go the same way.**

# Booking leave

What 14 days of annual leave buys you, with Sundays off

|                                        | Today | Even Keel |
|----------------------------------------|-------|-----------|
| Days off in a row — best place to book | 30    | 28        |
| Days off in a row — on average         | 23.4  | 23.4      |
| Days off in a row — worst place        | 19    | 20        |
| Leave for four full weeks off, at best | 14    | 15        |

**Best stretch 28 days, not 30; four full weeks off, Sunday to Saturday, costs 15 days' leave, not 14. Average the same, worst a day better.**

# More staff on the floor

More people rostered every day, at the open and the close

|                                              | Today       | Even Keel |
|----------------------------------------------|-------------|-----------|
| On duty on a weekday                         | 11–12       | 15        |
| On duty on a Saturday / Sunday               | 10 / 8      | 14 / 10   |
| Fewest rostered on the floor                 | 2           | 3         |
| Avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed rota | 4 (up to 5) | 0         |

**At least three rostered on the floor, and no avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed rota.**

# The honest trade-offs

Nothing is free — here is what it costs

## **Seven new shift times to learn**

Several of them are shorter versions of the lates you already work today.

## **Shifts about 2 minutes longer on average**

That is what keeps days at work to 219 a year or fewer on the same 35 hours.

## **Four weeks off: 15 days' leave, not 14**

Best 14-day stretch 28 days, not 30; average as today, worst a day better.

## **Two more Saturdays a year**

28 a year each, today 26 — fourteen on a Saturday, shared across 26 lines.

## **A few more late finishes**

44 a year each at 23:00 or later (today 39) — four to the close on a Saturday.

## **Still a proposal**

Your views count before a link is chosen, and who goes on which line is not decided.

**None of these is hidden: each one is on the full proposal sheet too.**

# At a glance

Today's roster and Even Keel, side by side

|                                              | Today                    | Even Keel                |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| Contracted hours a week                      | 35h                      | 35h                      |
| Contracted days at work a year               | 219.0                    | 218.6                    |
| Average shift · longest shift                | 8h 14m · 9h 10m          | 8h 16m · 9h 00m          |
| Closing shift: weekday · Saturday · Sunday   | 8h 40m · 9h 10m · 8h 55m | 8h 10m · 8h 40m · 8h 10m |
| Full weekends off, about a year              | 10                       | 14                       |
| Most days worked in a row                    | 7 (up to 9)              | 5 (up to 6)              |
| Shortest gap between two shifts              | 12h 30m                  | 14h 35m                  |
| Different shift times                        | 18                       | 15 (8 you know)          |
| On duty weekday · Saturday · Sunday          | 11–12 · 10 · 8           | 15 · 14 · 10             |
| Avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed rota | 4 (up to 5)              | 0                        |

**Same hours and days, shorter closers, more full weekends off.**



# What happens next

1. Look at the full proposal sheet — page 3 shows every week of the link
2. Tell us what worries you, even if it is small
3. Your feedback goes to the managers with the proposal

Even Keel · EK-26-H1 · every figure worked out from the rota by the Marylebone Roster app